

dependent on anyone to take care of my family. Now, I know that true happiness comes from "giving" and not "taking" from others and I am capable of "giving" now. I can now spend time and money on fulfilling the "true" goals of my life and spend time doing what I love doing rather than what fetches more money. Each and every moment now is worth living. After 40 years of existence on this planet, I have finally discovered life.

This book will lead you through a step by step journey on how I achieved it. It will also tell you under what circumstances I took some specific financial decisions so that you can map them to your circumstances and take a decision that is more appropriate for you. Anyone, even an absolute novice, without any prior knowledge about financial planning and financial freedom can benefit from my example, since I started from Ground Zero.

The financial planning exercises in the book starts with some fundamental definitions and terms one must know. It uses illustrative examples to explain those definitions. Once a basic understanding of the financial terms is developed, the book will walk you through all the financial investment options available today in the Indian market with the relative merits and demerits of all such options. All views expressed in this book are based on my personal experience and hence are illustrated with actual examples. I do not expect you to start investing just by reading these examples and using these investment tools. This book is intended to bring your financial literacy to the fore besides setting the right perspective for you to get a broader view of things.

Once the technicalities are clear, the book goes on to deal with the most critical, and often the most neglected aspect of such a journey. I realized that this is where most people fail. This is about the habitual changes that we all need to bring in ourselves if we have to successfully complete this journey. The book lists all healthy habits that I had to inculcate in myself and how I did that. Success principles do not change, and this includes financial success. You may have heard or read about many of these habits, but the key is how to implement them in one's own life.

Once you have the technical expertise and know what habitual changes are needed to be financially successful, the much awaited section of the book opens up. This section covers something which I never found in any book I read during my journey to financial freedom. It deals with my entire